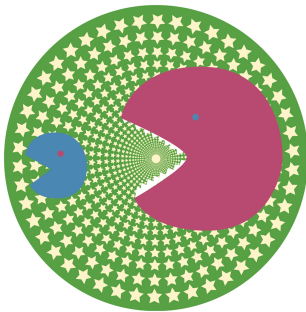


KEEPING UP-TO-DATE



Technology is advancing faster than ever, and producers are continually trying to persuade us to buy their latest products. Electronic goods in particular become obsolete fast, so last year's expensive smartphone, even if it still works perfectly, becomes worth next to nothing once technology has moved on.

THE BIG BOYS



In the face of competition from large corporations, many smaller firms have gone out of business or been bought up by larger firms. Some companies have grown so big that they are richer than many countries, and governments can't afford to ignore them.